feel normal." They had over $100,000 a year in discretionary spending but couldn't identify where the money went. It wasn't just one thing. There were shopping trips for things they didn't really want, Amazon boxes arriving with items they forgot they ever ordered, trips they took because of family obligations or social pressure. When pressed on how they could spend that much money on unnecessary "stuff," Alexis sheepishly admitted that her thought process was, "if the payment fits, I gets."

Joel and Alexis's awakening came after Alexis was involved in a car accident. Her car was totaled, but she escaped relatively unscathed. This close call made them step back, question how they were living, and determine what was truly important to them. They started paying attention to spending and focused on buying their FI instead of more stuff. In the process, they went from saving 7 percent of their income to saving over 80 percent in one year! Once they had a purpose, change came easily.

Joel retired within five years of Alexis's accident at thirty-three years of age. Alexis, a year younger, is in position to do the same. She continues to work because she continues to find value in working. The magnitude of change in such a short amount of time